LifeOS Domain Design Guide: Colors and UI for All 21 Domains

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Overview

Every one of the 21 domains gets its own color, icon and UI personality, so you can tell any block on the calendar at a glance and each domain page feels like its own room inside the same house.

Three recognition cues. Color alone is not enough on a crowded calendar or for color-blind users, so every domain is recognized by three things together: its unique color, its icon, and its signature element on the domain page.

Change from the main style guide. The main LifeOS Design Style Guide gave each of the 5 clusters one hue. With 21 domains, neighbors in the same cluster ended up too close to tell apart on the calendar. This guide replaces that rule: each domain has its own color spread around the color wheel, and clusters are shown by grouping and labels instead of by hue. Surfaces, typography, depth, motion and the violet accent are unchanged.

Note on the values. The colors are designed for the dark theme and are starting values to check on a real phone screen.

Domain palette

The 21 colors are spread around the color wheel and alternate between lighter and deeper tones, so neighbors never blend on the calendar. Meaning is used where it helps: red for Karate, orange for Food, gold for Finance, a night indigo for Sleep, and a near-white for Forward planning, the bird's-eye view.



domain palette · 21 colors in 5 clusters

Rules

- **Where domain colors appear.** Calendar blocks (a 3 px left bar plus a 20% tint), icon tiles, chips, progress rings and charts inside that domain's context. Nowhere else.
- **Never for status.** Done, needs attention, error and info use the meaning colors from the main style guide, always with an icon or a word. A domain color never means good or bad.
- **Same everywhere.** A domain keeps its color in the calendar, chat, notifications, reports and widgets.
- **Recoloring.** You can change a domain's color from a curated set of 24; a color already in use is blocked, so no two domains ever match.
- **Text on tint.** Text stays in the primary text color; the domain color is used for the bar, icon and ring, and must reach at least 3 to 1 against its surface.

- **Cluster labels.** Clusters appear as section headers on the Domains page and as groups in the layer filter, not as shared colors.

Identifying domains on the calendar

A block must be recognizable from a glance, even in a busy week, using color, icon and shape together.

Block anatomy. A 3 px bar on the left in the domain color, a 20% tint of that color behind, the domain icon at the top left, the title in primary text, and the time in secondary text. Changes of state use shape, not color:

- **Confirmed:** solid fill.
- **Suggested:** dashed border, softly breathing.
- **Protected tier 1:** small lock icon.
- **Travel and buffer blocks:** hatched fill in the owner domain's color.
- **Done:** a small check at the right; **missed:** muted, with no red.

Density	When	What shows
Roomy	Day view, tall blocks	Bar, tint, icon, title, time, domain name
Normal	Week view	Bar, tint, icon, title
Compact	Month view or very short blocks	A filled dot in the domain color plus a short title
Minimal	Month view with many events	Only colored dots, with a "+3" count

Finding and filtering

- **Legend.** A tap on the calendar title opens a legend of the 21 domains with color, icon and name, grouped by cluster.
- **Layer chips.** Chips show the domain icon and color and are grouped by cluster; long-press a chip to show only that domain, and a saved view remembers your favorites.
- **Focus on tap.** Tapping a block softly dims every other domain for a moment so its color and neighbors stand out.
- **Same cues elsewhere.** Notifications, chat change cards and reports use the same bar, icon and tint.

The shared domain page

All 21 domain pages use the same skeleton, so you always know where things are. Only the color, icon and one signature element change.

1. **Header.** A soft wash of the domain color fading into the background, the domain icon in a tinted tile, the domain name, and its cluster label in small text.
2. **Hero.** One key number in the display style inside a progress ring in the domain color (for example exam countdown, streak, hours this month).
3. **Signature element.** The domain's own widget (listed in the sections below), placed right under the hero.
4. **Tabs.** Tasks, Notes, Calendar and Goals, using the same order on every domain; the active tab uses the domain color's underline.
5. **Primary action.** One floating button in violet (the app accent, not the domain color), so the main action always looks the same.
6. **Empty state.** A small line illustration in the domain color, one sentence and one action.

Motion on entry. The header wash fades in first, the ring fills, and then the signature element rises into place, all within about 600 ms. Each domain adds one small motion of its own, described below, and all of it respects reduce motion.

Study and work

Domain	Color and icon	Personality	Signature element	Motion
Career	Azure #3E7BF0, briefcase	Confident, structured	Application board: stage columns with a progress bar per application	A card slides to the next stage and the follow-up task pops in
Education	Sky #4DB3F7, graduation cap	Focused, academic	Exam countdown ring plus a mastery heat map of topics	Heat cells fill as confidence rises
Competitions	Periwinkle #8F9BFF, trophy	Energetic, deadline-driven	Reverse-sprint bar with milestones (freeze, demo, rehearsals)	The countdown ticks; the bar pulses once in the last 24 hours

Domain	Color and icon	Personality	Signature element	Motion
Learning	Cyan #22C7E8, lightbulb	Curious, exploratory	Skill tree of connected nodes with locked and unlocked states	A newly unlocked node lights up and its link draws in
Open source	Lime #8FDA3E, git branch	Technical, precise; monospace for issue numbers	Ranked issue list with a fit meter per issue	The branch line draws from issue to pull request
Blogging	Magenta #E056D6, pen	Editorial, airy, lots of white space	Pipeline board from idea to publish with a word-count bar	A card flips to its next stage; the empty state shows a blinking caret
Portfolio	Berry #B8528E, award ribbon	Showcase, gallery-like	Evidence grid of cards with skill tags	A new entry stamps onto the grid with a soft thud

Body and health

These pages are the calmest. They use larger text, fewer elements and gentler motion, and the Medicine page avoids celebration entirely.

Domain	Color and icon	Personality	Signature element	Motion
Sleep	Indigo #5B5FD6, moon	Deep, quiet, low contrast; dims further at night	A 24-hour dial showing the sleep window, with a debt meter beside it	A slow breathing glow on the window; no sharp motion
Food	Orange #FF9F43, utensils	Warm, appetizing	Weekly meal strip with meal windows and prep markers	Meal chips slide into their windows; a batch-cook marker settles in

Domain	Color and icon	Personality	Signature element	Motion
Karate	Crimson #E5484D, belt or fist	Disciplined, crisp	Belt-path ladder from today to the grading date, with weekly drill steps	Quick, sharp snaps with no bounce; completed steps lock in
Medicine	Aqua #2DD4BF, pill	Clear, clinical-calm, extra-large text	Dose timeline for the day with taken, skipped and upcoming doses	Minimal: a firm tap confirmation, no confetti, no streak pressure
Rest and buffer	Sage #86D8B0, feather	Soft, spacious, slow	Slack meter showing buffer left each day as a soft water level	The level rises and falls slowly like a gentle wave

Mind and spirit

These pages are private by default. They show no scores, no red and no pressure, and their notifications use generic text.

Domain	Color and icon	Personality	Signature element	Motion
Prayer	Orchid #D17FF5, sunrise	Calm, reverent, minimal; no religious symbols unless you choose them	Sun-arc showing the day's prayer or worship times along the sun's path	The sun marker moves slowly along the arc; no sound by default
Mood reflections	Pink #F472B6, smile	Soft, gentle, private	Two-axis tap grid for mood and energy, and a weekly weather strip	Faces morph softly between states; no red, no rating verdicts
Habits and reflection	Rose #FB6F92, repeat arrows	Satisfying, rhythmic	Dot grid of days per habit, with softer dots for grace days	Each dot pops with a light haptic when ticked

Domain	Color and icon	Personality	Signature element	Motion
Forward planning	Moonstone #D9DCEF, compass	Spacious, big-picture	Life compass balance wheel with a spoke per domain	Spokes grow to this week's hours; the wheel turns slowly into place

People and service

Domain	Color and icon	Personality	Signature element	Motion
Volunteering	Leaf #3FC76A, handshake	Warm, community-minded	Monthly hours ring with a stack of impact notes	The ring fills as shifts are logged; a small thank-you sparkle once a target is reached
Social and mentors	Coral #FF7F6B, people	Friendly, human	Relationship orbit: people as dots around a ring, closer when you spoke recently	Dots drift gently; a soft ping on a dot when it is time to reach out (still when reduce motion is on)

Life admin

Domain	Color and icon	Personality	Signature element	Motion
Finance	Honey #E8B93F, wallet	Precise, trustworthy; no gamified money	Funding lane showing deadlines as covered or at risk, plus budget bars	Numbers count up smoothly; no confetti on money screens

Domain	Color and icon	Personality	Signature element	Motion
Admin	Olive #B5BC4A, checklist	Orderly, utilitarian	Deadline ladder (30, 14, 7 and 1 days) with a document checklist	Ladder steps tick off; a step slides up as its date nears
Travel and commute	Steel #8AA0BA, route	Light, directional	Door-to-door timeline with hatched travel blocks around each event	A dotted route line draws from start to destination

Consistency and accessibility checks

Run these checks before a color or icon is final.

- **Color-blind test.** View the calendar in simulated red-green and blue-yellow color blindness. Any two domains that look alike must still differ by icon and by block position in the legend.
- **Neighbor test.** Place every pair of domains side by side on the calendar. If two are hard to tell apart, change the lighter or deeper tone of one, not just its hue.
- **Contrast.** Each domain color against the surface must reach at least 3 to 1 (bar, icon, ring). Body text on a 20% tint must reach at least 4.5 to 1.
- **Status clash.** Domain colors that sit near the meaning colors (Karate near red, Finance near amber, Volunteering near green) never carry status; status always has an icon or a word.
- **Icon set.** All 21 icons come from one line-icon family at the same stroke and size, and each is readable at 16 px.
- **One name, one color.** A domain's color, icon and name are defined once in the domain config and read from there everywhere, so no screen can drift.
- **Light theme later.** If a light theme is added, darken each domain color by the same step instead of choosing new ones, so recognition carries over.

Implementation

Store each domain's color once in the domain config and expose it as a CSS variable, so the calendar, chat, notifications and reports read the same value.

```
:root {
  --d-career: #3E7BF0;       --d-education: #4DB3F7;
  --d-competitions: #8F9BFF; --d-learning: #22C7E8;
  --d-opensource: #8FDA3E;   --d-blogging: #E056D6;
  --d-portfolio: #B8528E;    --d-sleep: #5B5FD6;
  --d-food: #FF9F43;         --d-karate: #E5484D;
  --d-medicine: #2DD4BF;     --d-rest: #86D8B0;
  --d-prayer: #D17FF5;       --d-mood: #F472B6;
  --d-habits: #FB6F92;       --d-forward: #D9DCEF;
  --d-volunteering: #3FC76A; --d-social: #FF7F6B;
  --d-finance: #E8B93F;      --d-admin: #B5BC4A;
  --d-travel: #8AA0BA;
}
.event { --c: var(--d-career); border-left: 3px solid var(--c);
  background: color-mix(in srgb, var(--c) 20%, var(--surface)); }
```

Each event or card sets `--c` to its domain's variable, and the shared styles do the rest.

Rollout

Step	Work	Done check
1. Config	Add color, icon and cluster to each domain row; add the 21 variables	Changing one value updates every screen
2. Calendar	Block anatomy, density modes, legend and layer chips grouped by cluster	Every domain is recognizable in the week and month views
3. Domain page template	Header wash, hero ring, tabs and empty state	All 21 pages share the layout
4. Signature elements	Build them wave by wave, as each domain ships	Each domain page shows its own signature element
5. Audit	Color-blind, neighbor and contrast checks; test on a mid-range phone	All checks pass or have a written reason